Michael "Fitz" Fitzgerald

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Senior Frontend Engineer | React • Accessibility • Federal Modernization

I build production React applications for federal agencies and enterprise systems. 20+ years shipping accessible, maintainable frontends, from HRSA's multi-site Angular platform to CPSC's internal modernization system. Specialized in 508 compliance implementation, legacy system refactoring, and translating complex stakeholder requirements into clean, scalable code. My unique combination of frontend engineering depth and UX sensibility means I build systems that are both technically sound and genuinely usable.

Core Technical Skills

- **Frontend Engineering:** React, Angular, JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript
- **Styling & Architecture:** SASS, responsive design, component libraries, design systems
- **Accessibility:** WCAG 2.1 AA/AAA implementation, 508 compliance, ARIA, screen reader testing (JAWS)
- **Tools & Workflow:** Git, GitHub, Bitbucket, Jira, Agile/Scrum, CI/CD pipelines
- **Federal/Enterprise:** Security compliance, legacy modernization, stakeholder management, public trust clearance
- **Additional Capabilities:** UX prototyping (Figma, Axure), Graphic design (Illustrator, Photoshop), Firebase, Node.js, Express, SQLite, WordPress plugin development

Professional Experience

Senior Frontend Engineer (Contract) • 2025–Present

QuestRex Character Generator (Contract)

- Built complex React application with extensive state management for tabletop RPG system
- Architected modular component structure managing 50+ interconnected character creation fields
- Implemented dynamic validation and cascading dependencies based on user selections
- Designed file-based data architecture (JSON/Markdown) for zero-database portability
- Packaged as WordPress plugin for seamless site integration
- Live demo and open-source code available for technical review
- **Tech:** React.js, SASS, WordPress Plugin API, JavaScript

Squirl! Mobile App (Contract)

- Refactored React codebase from rough prototype to production-ready mobile social media app
- Rebuilt component architecture for performance, maintainability, and scalability
- Implemented responsive layouts and custom SASS styling system
- Collaborated with stakeholders to translate business requirements into technical specifications

- **Tech:** React.js, SASS, Figma, Replit

UrAtlas Odyssey (Contract)

- Architected and built full-stack accountability platform for life coaching practice
- Designed and implemented React frontend with real-time dashboards and data visualization
- Built Express/SQLite backend with RESTful API architecture and Firebase authentication
- Created flexible data model supporting both individual users and coach-managed groups
- **Tech:** React.js, Express, SQLite, Firebase Auth, Node.js

Publicis Sapient • Senior Frontend Engineer • 2013–2024

Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC) – React Modernization

- Built production React application to modernize legacy internal workflows for federal agency
- Implemented WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility standards across 40+ custom components
- Refactored poorly-defined requirements into scalable component architecture
- Conducted 508 compliance testing and remediation using JAWS and NVDA screen readers
- Collaborated with stakeholders through Agile sprints, wireframing sessions, and technical presentations
- **Tech:** React.js, SASS, Axure (wireframing), JAWS/508 testing

HRSA Health Workforce Connector – Multi-Site Angular Platform

- Developed component library and UX patterns deployed across 5+ federal healthcare websites
- Built Angular application from beta through production (Angular v1-v8 migration over project lifespan)
- Created reusable, accessibility-compliant components used by 3+ developer teams
- Maintained design system documentation and implementation standards
- **Tech:** Angular, SASS, TypeScript, Axure

PenFed Credit Union – Mobile Banking App

- Led CSS architecture and cross-platform styling for hybrid mobile banking application
- Ensured visual consistency across iOS, Android, and legacy device targets
- Optimized performance for low-bandwidth environments and older hardware
- **Tech:** PhoneGap (Cordova), HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript

Education & Additional Information

- **Education:** BA, Communications – Old Dominion University
- **Clearance:** U.S. Citizen, have held multiple public trust clearances, open to clearance sponsorship
- **References:** Available upon request